

Independent nation

In the early days, Australia consisted of six separate colonies. Each had its own administration but was subject to the sovereignty of Britain. As the agricultural and mining industries grew in strength, the six colonies began to work closely together. In 1901, Australia gained its independence from Britain, and a federal government for the entire country was established with its capital in Melbourne. Today, the federal capital is at Canberra.

Gallipoli

On 25 April, 1915, ANZAC forces landed at Gallipoli at the approaches to the Black Sea, Turkey. They hoped to take Constantinople (modern-day Istanbul) and force Germany's World War I ally, Turkey, out of the war. The men showed extraordinary courage and spirit, but the campaign was a disaster. No important gains were made and more than 11,400 ANZAC troops lost their lives.



Gallipoli memorial

Anzac Monument, Sydney



ANZAC forces

Australian and New Zealand forces fought for Britain in the Boer War (1899–1902) in South Africa and in both world wars. They fought together as the Australia and New Zealand Army Corps (ANZAC), making a contribution out of all proportion to their size. They suffered huge casualties, but the effort forged a strong sense of national identity.

Modern Australia

After World War II, Australia continued its military alliance with the USA. The country sent troops to fight with the Americans in Korea during the 1950s and Vietnam in the 1960s. In recent years, those ties have weakened, and Australia has increasingly turned towards Asia, in particular Japan, for trade and investment. Today, Australia is an important trading partner with most of the powerful East Asian economies.

National symbol

Sydney Opera House, with its bold concrete roofs, has become the most widely recognized symbol of Australia.



Australian republic?

In 1992, the prime minister, Paul Keating, said he wanted the country to be a republic by the year 2000, with an Australian as the head of state, instead of the British monarch. However, a referendum held in 1999 defeated any such proposals.



Skyscraper, Sydney

Chinese festival, Sydney



Multicultural Australia

Modern Australia is a multi-racial state with large Chinese and Greek populations. However, the Aborigines are fighting a long campaign to be included in society and to secure their land rights and civil liberties.



Sailing in Sydney Harbour

Sports excellence

One way in which Australia has expressed its national identity is through sporting activities. There have been notable successes in sports as diverse as cricket and yachting. For example, in 1983 Australia overturned a century of US yachting dominance by winning the America's Cup. Sydney was chosen as the site of the Olympic Games in 2000.

Dominion status

When Australia became independent in 1901, it remained a Dominion of the British Empire and kept close links with its former ruler. But many people had few ties to the old "Mother Country". The threat of Japanese invasion during World War II led to closer links with the USA as the only power that could defend Australia.



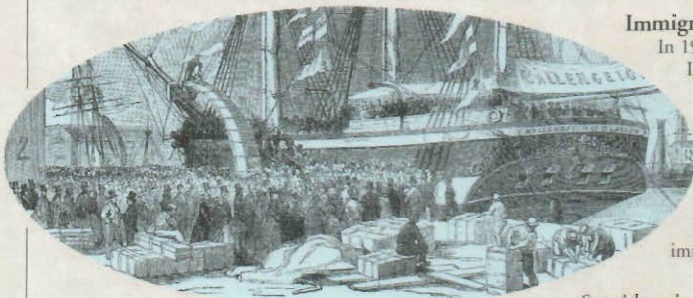
The Federation Flag was based on the state flag of New South Wales.

Federation Flag

Immigration

In 1902, the government passed the Immigration Restriction Act to limit Chinese immigration. The act required settlers to speak a European language, and began a White Australia policy that lasted until the 1970s. Britons, Greeks, and Italians flooded into Australia in the 1950s and 1960s, but immigration from Asia later increased.

Scottish emigrants leave for Australia.



Timeline

c.40,000 BC Aborigines arrive in Australia.

1642–43 Tasman names Van Diemen's Land (Tasmania).

1770 Captain Cook lands at Botany Bay.

1788 First British convicts arrive.

1828 Charles Sturt begins to explore Murray and Darling rivers.



Wallaby

1851 Gold discovered in Victoria and New South Wales.

1860–61 Burke and Wills cross Australia from south to north.

1868 Britain abolishes the transportation of convicts.

Aboriginal digging sticks



1901 Australia becomes self-governing dominion in the British Empire.

1902 Immigration Restriction Act establishes the White Australia policy.

1914–18 60,000 Australians are killed fighting for Britain in World War I.

1927 Parliament meets for the first time in the new federal capital of Canberra.

1970s White Australia policy abolished.

1993 Aboriginal land rights recognized by law.

2000 Olympic Games held in Sydney.

2001 Fierce bush fires cause immense damage.

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CRIME AND PUNISHMENT

COOK, JAMES

EXPLORATION

OPERA

PREHISTORIC PEOPLE

WORLD WAR I

WORLD WAR II